

**THE QUESTION**

One page. One question. Nothing competes with it.

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# How well do the Army's Officer and Other Rank promotion continuums align with the intent and design of the LDF?

AITC discussion piece · NZALC · DRAFT

[No subtitle. No agenda. No sources. Those come on page 2.]

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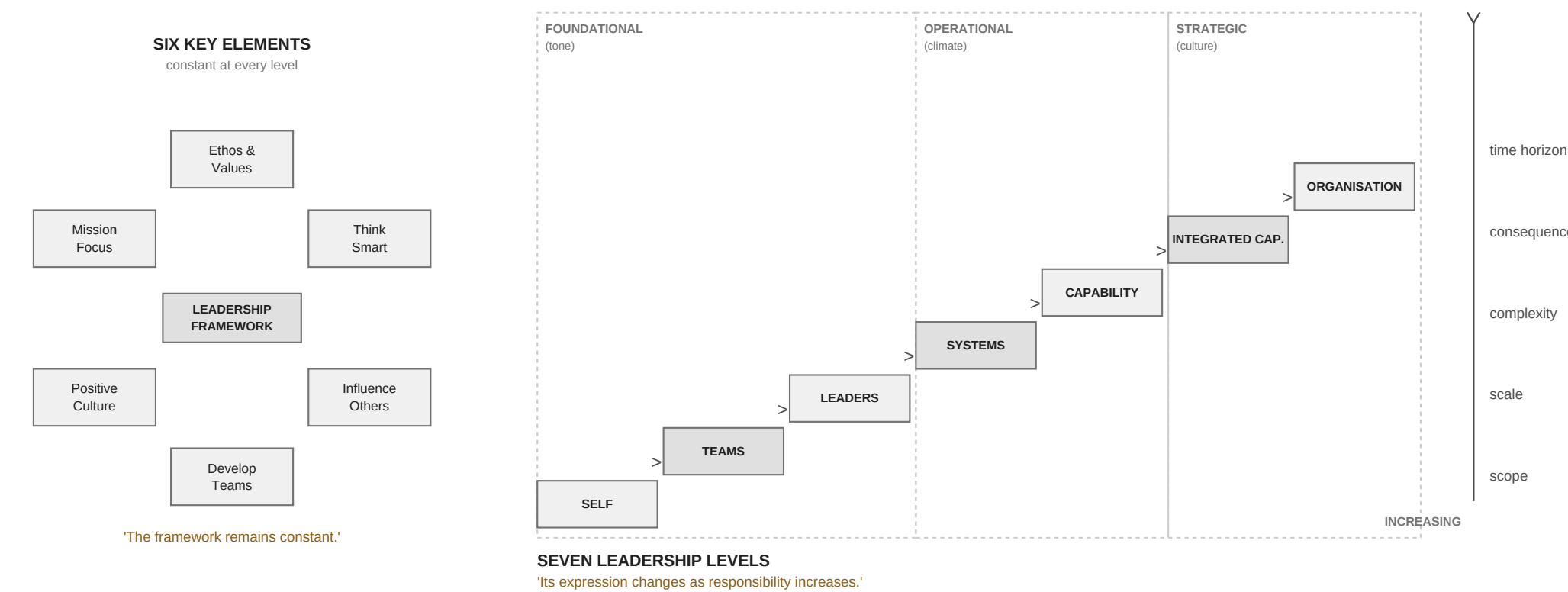
**VISUAL LOGIC**

This is COMDT's tasking in his own terms, so AITC recognises it as the question they asked. Type only, generous white space, one weight. 'How well' signals a graded answer. The sharper analytical test (deliberate development at each transition, linked to promotion) is applied on pages 4 to 6, not stated here.

THE SYSTEM WE ALREADY HAVE

Six constant elements + seven progressive levels + increasing scope. Source material simplified into one picture.

LDF: the NZDF Leadership Framework (six Key Elements) and Leadership Development System (seven levels), taken together.

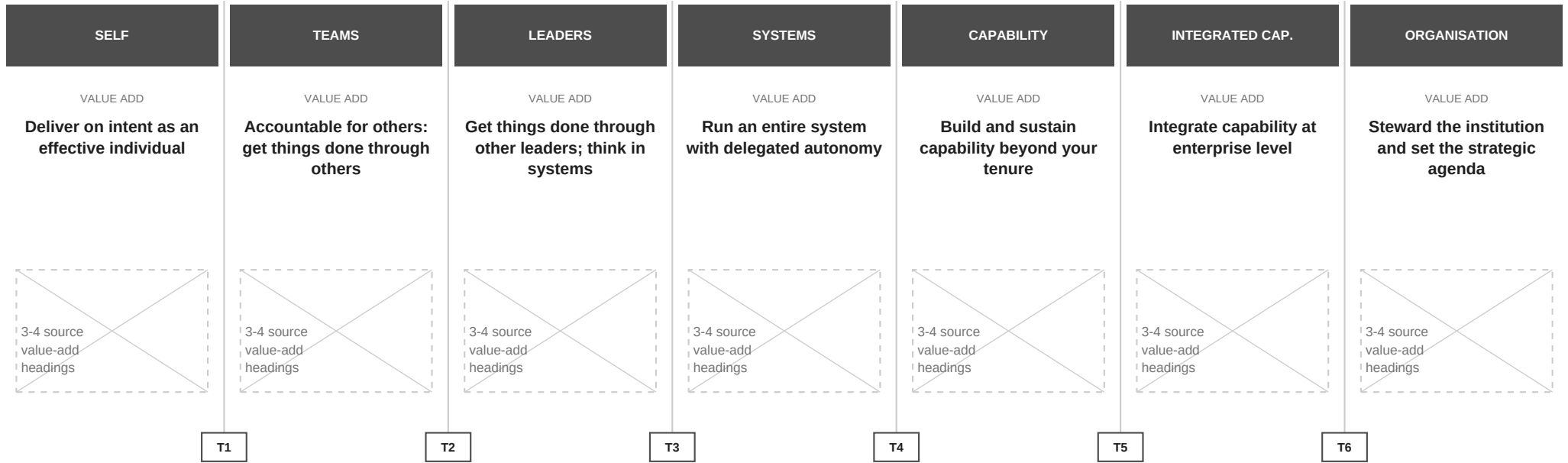


THE FRAMEWORK REMAINS CONSTANT. ITS EXPRESSION CHANGES AS LEADERSHIP RESPONSIBILITY INCREASES.

**VISUAL LOGIC**  
Three source posters become one picture: the ring (what), the staircase (progression), the axis (why the progression is hard). The three LDF environments are shown as faint bands so the reader sees that Foundational, Operational and Strategic are where mindset changes cluster. No behaviour statements appear here; they live in the source document, not the brief.

WHAT ACTUALLY CHANGES?

Seven levels, one line each. Promotion into greater responsibility is a developmental transition, not a change of rank.



T1 to T6 are the six transitions. From page 4 onward the TRANSITION, not the level, is the row.

WHAT THE LDF SAYS SHIFTS AT EACH STEP (from the Value Adds and level introductions)

|                  |                |                                   |                            |                              |                               |                                |
|------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| intent & mastery | through others | through leaders; systems thinking | run the system; succession | beyond tenure; advise upward | enterprise; external partners | stewardship; ministerial trust |
|------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|

VISUAL LOGIC

Each column carries one bold sentence, verified against the level's Value Adds. The dashed placeholders hold the three or four Value Add headings from the source so the sentence is traceable, not invented. The T1 to T6 gates are introduced here and reused on every following page.

TWO CAREER SYSTEMS. ONE LEADERSHIP FRAMEWORK.

The centrepiece. Officer left, Other Rank right, the LDF spine fixed in the middle. Rows are transitions, not levels.

THE TEST AT EACH TRANSITION: does the continuum deliberately develop the individual for the change in leadership required, and is that development linked to promotion?

| OFFICER CONTINUUM |               |                |                                          |                              |                          | NZDF LDF TRANSITIONS                                                                                                             | OTHER RANK CONTINUUM          |                              |                                          |                |               |               |
|-------------------|---------------|----------------|------------------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------|---------------|---------------|
| Assurance         | Timing        | Career linkage | Formal development                       | Appointment / responsibility | Rank / career point      |                                                                                                                                  | Rank / career point           | Appointment / responsibility | Formal development                       | Career linkage | Timing        | Assurance     |
| .                 | .             | .              | embedded in single-Service courses (LDS) | .                            | OCDT > JO (LDS estimate) | <div>T1</div> <b>SELF &gt; TEAMS</b><br><br>WHAT CHANGES: Accountable for others: get things done through others                 | PTE > LCPL/CPL (LDS estimate) | .                            | embedded in single-Service courses (LDS) | .              | .             | .             |
| DATA REQUIRED     | DATA REQUIRED | DATA REQUIRED  | TO CONFIRM                               | DATA REQUIRED                | TO CONFIRM               |                                                                                                                                  | TO CONFIRM                    | DATA REQUIRED                | TO CONFIRM                               | DATA REQUIRED  | DATA REQUIRED | DATA REQUIRED |
| .                 | .             | .              | single-Service provider (LDS)            | .                            | JO (LDS estimate)        | <div>T2</div> <b>TEAMS &gt; LEADERS</b><br><br>WHAT CHANGES: Get things done through other leaders; think in systems             | SGT/SSGT (LDS estimate)       | .                            | single-Service provider (LDS)            | .              | .             | .             |
| DATA REQUIRED     | DATA REQUIRED | DATA REQUIRED  | TO CONFIRM                               | DATA REQUIRED                | TO CONFIRM               |                                                                                                                                  | TO CONFIRM                    | DATA REQUIRED                | TO CONFIRM                               | DATA REQUIRED  | DATA REQUIRED | DATA REQUIRED |
| .                 | .             | .              | ILD delivers LDS course                  | .                            | MAJ (LDS estimate)       | <div>T3</div> <b>LEADERS &gt; SYSTEMS</b><br><br>WHAT CHANGES: Run an entire system with delegated autonomy                      | WO (LDS estimate)             | .                            | ILD delivers LDS course                  | .              | .             | .             |
| DATA REQUIRED     | DATA REQUIRED | DATA REQUIRED  | TO CONFIRM                               | DATA REQUIRED                | TO CONFIRM               |                                                                                                                                  | TO CONFIRM                    | DATA REQUIRED                | TO CONFIRM                               | DATA REQUIRED  | DATA REQUIRED | DATA REQUIRED |
| .                 | .             | .              | ILD delivers LDS course                  | .                            | LTCOL (LDS estimate)     | <div>T4</div> <b>SYSTEMS &gt; CAPABILITY</b><br><br>WHAT CHANGES: Build and sustain capability beyond your tenure                | Tier 5 WO (LDS estimate)      | .                            | ILD delivers LDS course                  | .              | .             | .             |
| DATA REQUIRED     | DATA REQUIRED | DATA REQUIRED  | TO CONFIRM                               | DATA REQUIRED                | TO CONFIRM               |                                                                                                                                  | TO CONFIRM                    | DATA REQUIRED                | TO CONFIRM                               | DATA REQUIRED  | DATA REQUIRED | DATA REQUIRED |
| .                 | .             | .              | ILD delivers LDS course                  | .                            | COL (LDS estimate)       | <div>T5</div> <b>CAPABILITY &gt; INTEGRATED CAP.</b><br><br>WHAT CHANGES: Integrate capability at enterprise level               | Tier 4 WO (LDS estimate)      | .                            | ILD delivers LDS course                  | .              | .             | .             |
| DATA REQUIRED     | DATA REQUIRED | DATA REQUIRED  | TO CONFIRM                               | DATA REQUIRED                | TO CONFIRM               |                                                                                                                                  | TO CONFIRM                    | DATA REQUIRED                | TO CONFIRM                               | DATA REQUIRED  | DATA REQUIRED | DATA REQUIRED |
| .                 | .             | .              | ILD delivers LDS course                  | .                            | BRIG+ (LDS estimate)     | <div>T6</div> <b>INTEGRATED CAP. &gt; ORGANISATION</b><br><br>WHAT CHANGES: Steward the institution and set the strategic agenda | Tier 3 WO+ (LDS estimate)     | .                            | ILD delivers LDS course                  | .              | .             | .             |
| DATA REQUIRED     | DATA REQUIRED | DATA REQUIRED  | TO CONFIRM                               | DATA REQUIRED                | TO CONFIRM               |                                                                                                                                  | TO CONFIRM                    | DATA REQUIRED                | TO CONFIRM                               | DATA REQUIRED  | DATA REQUIRED | DATA REQUIRED |

Status chips: KNOWN (from source) · TO CONFIRM (source is an estimate or a session document) · DATA REQUIRED (nothing in hand). Colour comes later; the chip text is the primary signal.

VISUAL LOGIC

Reading order is deliberate: the eye lands on the dark spine, reads a transition and 'what changes', then looks left (officer) and right (OR) to test whether each system prepares for that change. Officer columns run right-to-left so the two sides mirror around the spine and the same category sits at the same distance from it. Populated cells here are limited to what the four sources state: the LDS course delivery model per level and the rank-to-level estimate from the Leadership Levels poster (itself marked 'only an estimation'). Everything else is a grey DATA REQUIRED chip.

WHERE DO THE SYSTEMS ALIGN?

Same matrix. Only demonstrable connections stay solid; everything else recedes.

THE TEST AT EACH TRANSITION: does the continuum deliberately develop the individual for the change in leadership required, and is that development linked to promotion?

| OFFICER CONTINUUM |        |                |                    |                              |                     | NZDF LDF TRANSITIONS                                                                                    | OTHER RANK CONTINUUM |                              |                    |                |        |           |
|-------------------|--------|----------------|--------------------|------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|------------------------------|--------------------|----------------|--------|-----------|
| Assurance         | Timing | Career linkage | Formal development | Appointment / responsibility | Rank / career point |                                                                                                         | Rank / career point  | Appointment / responsibility | Formal development | Career linkage | Timing | Assurance |
| .                 | .      | .              | ALIGNED?           | .                            | .                   | T1 SELF > TEAMS<br>WHAT CHANGES: Accountable for others: get things done through others                 | .                    | .                            | ALIGNED?           | .              | .      | .         |
| .                 | .      | .              | ALIGNED?           | .                            | .                   | T2 TEAMS > LEADERS<br>WHAT CHANGES: Get things done through other leaders; think in systems             | .                    | .                            | ALIGNED?           | .              | .      | .         |
| .                 | .      | .              | .                  | .                            | .                   | T3 LEADERS > SYSTEMS<br>WHAT CHANGES: Run an entire system with delegated autonomy                      | .                    | .                            | .                  | .              | .      | .         |
| .                 | .      | .              | .                  | .                            | .                   | T4 SYSTEMS > CAPABILITY<br>WHAT CHANGES: Build and sustain capability beyond your tenure                | .                    | .                            | .                  | .              | .      | .         |
| .                 | .      | .              | .                  | .                            | .                   | T5 CAPABILITY > INTEGRATED CAP.<br>WHAT CHANGES: Integrate capability at enterprise level               | .                    | .                            | .                  | .              | .      | .         |
| .                 | .      | .              | .                  | .                            | .                   | T6 INTEGRATED CAP. > ORGANISATION<br>WHAT CHANGES: Steward the institution and set the strategic agenda | .                    | .                            | .                  | .              | .      | .         |

Solid cell = evidence in hand that development, career point and consequence connect. Faded cell = not shown on this page, not 'no'.

VISUAL LOGIC

This page is the positive case. It uses the identical grid so the reader is not re-orienting, and simply removes what is not aligned. In the polished version aligned cells are green and linked to the spine with a short connector; nothing else is coloured. The two cells shown solid are illustrative of the treatment only; which cells qualify is decided by the data, not by this wireframe.

WHERE ARE THE GAPS?

Same matrix. Each gap is named by type, so the reader sees the nature of the problem, not just a red cell.

THE TEST AT EACH TRANSITION:    does the continuum deliberately develop the individual for the change in leadership required, and is that development linked to promotion?

| OFFICER CONTINUUM |             |                |                    |                              |                     | NZDF LDF TRANSITIONS                                                                                                         | OTHER RANK CONTINUUM |                              |                    |                |             |             |
|-------------------|-------------|----------------|--------------------|------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|------------------------------|--------------------|----------------|-------------|-------------|
| Assurance         | Timing      | Career linkage | Formal development | Appointment / responsibility | Rank / career point |                                                                                                                              | Rank / career point  | Appointment / responsibility | Formal development | Career linkage | Timing      | Assurance   |
|                   |             |                |                    |                              |                     | <div>T1</div> <b>SELF &gt; TEAMS</b><br>WHAT CHANGES: Accountable for others: get things done through others                 |                      |                              |                    |                |             |             |
| DATA              | ASSURANCE   | CONSEQUENCE    | DATA               | DATA                         | DATA                |                                                                                                                              | DATA                 | DATA                         | DATA               | CONSEQUENCE    | ASSURANCE   | DATA        |
|                   |             |                |                    |                              |                     | <div>T2</div> <b>TEAMS &gt; LEADERS</b><br>WHAT CHANGES: Get things done through other leaders; think in systems             |                      |                              |                    |                |             |             |
| DEVELOPMENT       | DATA        | ASSURANCE      | DATA               | DATA                         | DATA                |                                                                                                                              | DATA                 | DATA                         | DATA               | ASSURANCE      | DATA        | DEVELOPMENT |
|                   |             |                |                    |                              |                     | <div>T3</div> <b>LEADERS &gt; SYSTEMS</b><br>WHAT CHANGES: Run an entire system with delegated autonomy                      |                      |                              |                    |                |             |             |
| ALIGNMENT         | DEVELOPMENT | DATA           | DATA               | DATA                         | DATA                |                                                                                                                              | DATA                 | DATA                         | DATA               | DATA           | DEVELOPMENT | ALIGNMENT   |
|                   |             |                |                    |                              |                     | <div>T4</div> <b>SYSTEMS &gt; CAPABILITY</b><br>WHAT CHANGES: Build and sustain capability beyond your tenure                |                      |                              |                    |                |             |             |
| TIMING            | ALIGNMENT   | DEVELOPMENT    | DATA               | DATA                         | DATA                |                                                                                                                              | DATA                 | DATA                         | DATA               | DEVELOPMENT    | ALIGNMENT   | TIMING      |
|                   |             |                |                    |                              |                     | <div>T5</div> <b>CAPABILITY &gt; INTEGRATED CAP.</b><br>WHAT CHANGES: Integrate capability at enterprise level               |                      |                              |                    |                |             |             |
| CONSEQUENCE       | TIMING      | ALIGNMENT      | DATA               | DATA                         | DATA                |                                                                                                                              | DATA                 | DATA                         | DATA               | ALIGNMENT      | TIMING      | CONSEQUENCE |
|                   |             |                |                    |                              |                     | <div>T6</div> <b>INTEGRATED CAP. &gt; ORGANISATION</b><br>WHAT CHANGES: Steward the institution and set the strategic agenda |                      |                              |                    |                |             |             |
| ASSURANCE         | CONSEQUENCE | TIMING         | DATA               | DATA                         | DATA                |                                                                                                                              | DATA                 | DATA                         | DATA               | TIMING         | CONSEQUENCE | ASSURANCE   |

GAP TAXONOMY

- DEVELOPMENT

no deliberate development for the transition
- ALIGNMENT

development exists but does not match the LDF shift
- TIMING

development occurs after the transition
- CONSEQUENCE

development has no formal link to promotion or appointment
- ASSURANCE

no mechanism establishes readiness
- DATA

insufficient information

VISUAL LOGIC

Tags shown here are placeholders to test density, not findings. Amber and red are reserved for this page and page 5; the tag text carries the meaning so the page still works in greyscale. Officer-versus-OR asymmetries are read across a row: the same transition, two different answers. Where evidence is thin the tag is DATA, never a judgement.

THE QUESTION FOR ARMY

End at the strategic level. No answer is predetermined.

Given these facts, how should Army decide about the development of leaders at all levels?

PROMOTION

[the three levers AITC controls; no recommendation attached]

APPOINTMENT

[the three levers AITC controls; no recommendation attached]

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

[the three levers AITC controls; no recommendation attached]